

Tips & Tricks

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

TIPS

Microsoft Office 2007
Windows XP

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30 MINUTES EXPERT

Blender 3D Modeler

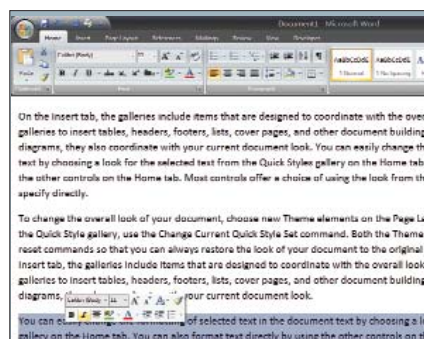
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MS OFFICE 2007



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

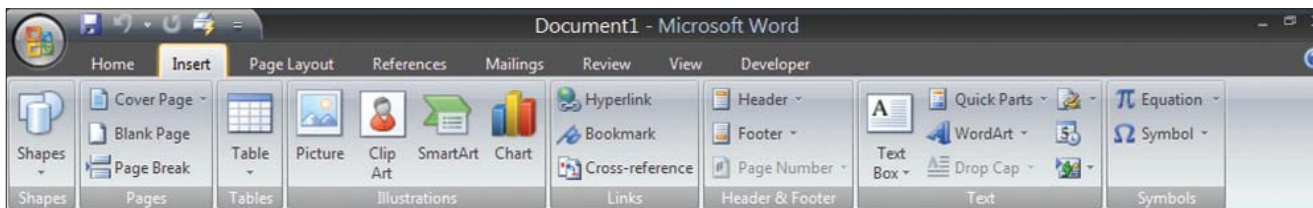
The next version of Microsoft's popular Office suite, Office 2007, is currently in Beta 2 stage. However, it's never too early to get started. Most of you might already have installed the Beta 1 version that we provided on our August 2006 DVD, so here are some tips that will help you master Office 2007.



A new look and feel for Microsoft Office

The Ribbon

The very first thing users will notice is the enhanced toolbar, called "The Ribbon." Microsoft has provided this Ribbon so as to reduce the number of mouse clicks needed to accomplish tasks and get to the option you want. This also increases the visibility of various features and options, which a lot of regular users might not have seen earlier. Another good thing is that this is quite consistent across the applications, so Excel, Word, and PowerPoint all have the same look. Take a look at the screenshots to better understand the new look. You can click on the different tabs to get different options.



A closer look at the Ribbon: You can see that features and options that were previously hidden in menus are now available at a mouse-click

Keyboard-Friendly

With the introduction of "The Ribbon," Microsoft Office 2007 looks very different from previous versions. This Ribbon appears to be more mouse-friendly, and a lot of keyboard warriors may feel left out.

This is especially true because quite a few advanced keyboard shortcuts have been changed.

However, a quick way to check for the keyboard shortcut that you need is to press and release [Alt]. When you do this, you will see all the keyboard shortcuts possible.

Live Previews

The best addition to Office 2007 is the live previews it offers. For example, when you want to change the font for headlines, instead of selecting the headline and then applying each font one by one, to try and figure out which the best option is, all you need to do is click on the Font dropdown, and move your mouse over the name of the font you want to try.

The selected text is automatically changed to the font highlighted by the cursor. This way, you can scroll through your entire font set and see how each one of them looks, without ever needing to apply any changes to the document.

The same holds true for most other options, such as selecting a page theme, changing font sizes, colours, highlighting, etc. So, for an increase in productivity, make sure you use this cool feature.

The Only Pop-Up We Like!

When you highlight text or fields in Office 2007 documents and right-click, you will see a little pop-up on the top right of the selection that allows you to accomplish many common tasks—a mini toolbar.

You can even make this toolbar appear semi-transparent when you hover over your highlighted text. You can change the font, font colour, highlighting colour, alignment, indents, insert images, format paint, etc.

Once you get used to this, you will find you can save a lot of time and effort—no need to go to the top-left of the screen and change the font; just do it anywhere in the document.